

CHAPTER 11

Home Made, Tailor Made and Readymade Garments

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LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- **To gain knowledge on the methods of garment manufacturing**
- **To learn the differences among home-made, tailor made and readymade garments**

11.1 Introduction

Clothing has always been important to people because it meets one of their primary needs of human being. Thus, clothing and textiles tend to reflect and offer an important basis for interpreting the social, economic, and political conditions of a nation. Clothing industry or the fashion industry is also a part of garment or apparel industry. The origin of apparel industry dates back to Stone Age when man used leaves, barks and animal skin for covering oneself for protection from climatic conditions.

The apparel industry in the United States has gone through several stages, as follows:

- **The Family Stage**

During which all clothing was made at home by family members.

- **The Hired Stage**

In this stage, families engaged a dressmaker or tailor to come into their homes and make their clothing.

- **The Customer Stage**

In this stage dressmakers or tailors maintained shops to which patrons came to have their clothing made.

- **The Commercial Stage**

This introduced men's and women's furnishing stores that featured ready to wear as well as custom apparel; and

- **The Manufacturing Stage**

This supplied readymade clothing for retail and wholesale trade. There has been considerable over lapping of these methods of clothing production, so that all five stages may be found in most periods of our history.

As the nation became more prosperous and secure, people showed more interest in fashion. Around 1800 century, the custom tailor shops appeared. Here the independent tailor made garments for his customers were made on special order. The seamstress appeared somewhat later. Seamstresses set up shops

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